



ORIENTATION OFFICER PROFESSION

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Vocation

Orientation Officer is a vocation, not an executive rotation, Chief-of-Staff credential, or stepping stone into power. The working corps target is approximately 20–25 commissioned officers; fellows/trainees may sit outside it. Officer, Senior Officer, and Distinguished Officer are possible rank directions, not final nomenclature. Distinguished status means expertise, respect, compensation, freedom, and professional contribution—not a people-management empire.

In exchange for exceptional compensation, unparalleled institutional access, intellectual freedom, research resources, sabbaticals, field exposure, education, and prestige, an ordinary commissioned officer permanently gives up later C-suite line office, operating VP authority, voting board membership, and equivalent decision-making power. The Head/Director remains inside the profession rather than converting to line command. Whether a former Head could later become a nonexecutive director remains OPEN and no exception is implied.

Work in decision environments

The officer knows the state, provenance, confidence, dissent, and limits of what Sable Harbor thinks it knows. In an executive or board room the officer has a narrow standing duty to intervene when material uncertainty is represented as fact, consequential dissent is omitted, confidence materially overstated, or a known information deficiency matters. The officer does not vote, direct the outcome, own the agenda, or automatically delay. “Noted and proceeding” is a valid response.

The Office of CEO and Board receive separate dedicated officers. The Board officer attends key board/committee meetings, supports the EIB, clarifies confidence/dissent/unknowns/judgment ownership, and may meet independent directors without management where appropriate. This is protection from exclusively management-filtered understanding, not a gotcha mechanism.

Finance is a standing observation post because beliefs become numbers people later mistake for facts. A senior officer works with the CFO office and approximately 2–3 embeds work across planning/performance areas as a refinable model. They sit with model builders, ask where assumptions came from and who owns them, connect them to Judgment Problems, inspect actual operations, and ask what variance taught about the belief beneath the number.

Temporary assignments follow consequential uncertainty: major acquisition, Red Wash expansion, transformative capital program, new regulated exposure, or similar environment. Presence is not a prestige perk.

Anti-court architecture

Officers do not own operating deliverables, supervise line employees, control budgets, conduct personnel actions, gatekeep executive access or calendars, broker politics, map who is politically rising/falling, stockpile private intelligence, say “we” for an executive’s business decision, or convert access into future executive power.

Material institutional information returns to the system through appropriate channels. Sable Harbor preserves judgments, dissent, assumptions, decisions, and knowledge changes; it deliberately does not build a forensic graph reconstructing which officer influenced which executive. Such a graph would be incomplete, scapegoating-prone, and itself politically toxic.

Executive-office assignments rotate approximately 24–36 months. Language names the office—“Orientation Officer assigned to the Office of the CEO”—not the person. Most officers are not permanently attached; they also work enterprise questions, EIB, Canon, research, field immersion, Education, and study tours.

Professional self-government

Orientation is trusted to orient itself through a named Head/Director and a strong culture of professional challenge. There is no permanent steering committee above its thinking. The Head is first among rigor, not a czar of institutional truth.

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